

3-MONTH TRAINING PROGRAM

Web Development Mastery Roadmap

A structured zero-to-expert plan covering modern front-end, custom PHP & MySQL, WordPress development, and professional SEO — built for a student moving from basics to job-ready expert.

WordPress

Custom PHP

SEO

HTML / CSS / JS

MySQL

WooCommerce

NEXVORA

Training & Mentorship Track • Prepared for Student Onboarding

12

WEEKS

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Program Overview & Ground Rules

This roadmap turns a beginner (with a basic computer course + basic programming knowledge) into a confident, hireable web developer in 12 focused weeks. Every week has a goal, daily tasks, a mini-project, and one complex challenge that forces real problem-solving.

How the 3 months are split

Phase	Focus	What you can build by the end
Month 1 Weeks 1–4	Foundations	Responsive static websites with HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and your first dynamic PHP + MySQL pages.
Month 2 Weeks 5–8	Core Development	A full custom PHP/MySQL web app (login + CRUD), plus your own WordPress theme built from scratch.
Month 3 Weeks 9–12	Expert + SEO	Advanced WordPress (CPT, ACF, WooCommerce), full SEO optimization, and 3 portfolio capstone projects.

Daily commitment & method

Item	Recommendation
Time per day	3–4 hours (1 hr learning concept · 2–3 hrs hands-on coding). 6 days a week, Day 7 = review + revision.
Learning rule	70% building, 30% watching/reading. Never watch a tutorial without coding along and then rebuilding it from memory.
Version control	Push every mini-project to GitHub from Week 2 onward. By Month 3 the GitHub profile becomes part of the portfolio.
Notes	Maintain a personal "cheat-sheet" doc — every new function, hook, or CSS trick gets written in own words.

Tools to install in Week 1 (the setup checklist)

VS Code + extensions (Prettier, Live Server, PHP Intelephense)

Local server: XAMPP or Local by Flywheel

Git + a GitHub account

Google Chrome + DevTools

A modern browser for testing (Firefox)

Figma (free) for reading designs

FileZilla (FTP) — needed in Month 3

TablePlus / phpMyAdmin for the database

The golden rule of this roadmap

Don't move to the next week until the current week's **mini-project** works AND the **complex challenge** is at least attempted. Speed is good, but a finished imperfect project beats a perfect unfinished tutorial. Output > theory.

Month 1 — Foundations

Goal of the month: be able to take any design and turn it into a clean, responsive, working website — and write your first dynamic, database-driven PHP pages.

WEEK 1

HTML5 & CSS3 Fundamentals

Build any static page structure and style it with confidence. Understand the box model deeply.

TOPICS

- › HTML5 semantic tags (header, nav, section, article, footer)
- › Text, links, images, lists, tables, forms & inputs
- › CSS selectors, specificity, the cascade
- › Box model: margin, border, padding, content
- › Colors, units (px, %, em, rem), typography
- › Display: block, inline, inline-block
- › Positioning: static, relative, absolute, fixed

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Tooling setup + HTML document structure
- › **Day 2:** All text/media/link/list tags
- › **Day 3:** Forms & tables
- › **Day 4:** CSS basics + selectors + box model
- › **Day 5:** Typography, colors, backgrounds
- › **Day 6:** Positioning + build mini-project
- › **Day 7:** Review & rebuild from memory

MINI-PROJECT

Personal Profile Card + Resume Page. A single static HTML/CSS page: photo, bio, a skills table, a contact section. Must use semantic tags and look intentional (not default browser styling).

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Pixel-clone a real landing page. Pick any simple SaaS/agency homepage and recreate the top section (logo bar + hero + 3 feature boxes) using only HTML & CSS — no framework. Match spacing, colors and fonts as close as possible.

Responsive Design, Flexbox, Grid & Git

Make every layout work on mobile, tablet and desktop. Start using Git like a professional.

TOPICS

- › Flexbox: axis, justify, align, wrap, gap
- › CSS Grid: rows, columns, areas, auto-fit/fill
- › Media queries & mobile-first thinking
- › Responsive images & units (vw, vh, clamp)
- › Transitions, transforms, basic animation
- › Intro to a framework: Bootstrap 5 OR Tailwind
- › Git: init, add, commit, branch, push, GitHub

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Flexbox deep dive (Flexbox Froggy)
- › **Day 2:** CSS Grid (Grid Garden)
- › **Day 3:** Media queries + responsive nav
- › **Day 4:** Transitions/animations
- › **Day 5:** Bootstrap or Tailwind crash course
- › **Day 6:** Git + first GitHub repo + project
- › **Day 7:** Review & responsive testing

MINI-PROJECT

Fully responsive business landing page. Hero, services grid, about, testimonials, contact form, footer. Must work perfectly on mobile with a working hamburger menu. Push to GitHub + deploy free on Netlify.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

One design, two ways. Build the same restaurant landing page *twice* — once with pure CSS (Flexbox/Grid) and once with Bootstrap. Compare your code, speed, and which felt cleaner. Write 5 lines on what you learned.

JavaScript Fundamentals & the DOM

Add real interactivity. Understand how JS reads and changes the page.

TOPICS

- › Variables, data types, operators
- › Conditionals, loops, functions, arrays, objects
- › DOM selection & manipulation
- › Events: click, input, submit, mouseover
- › Form validation with JS
- › ES6: arrow functions, template literals, let/const
- › Intro to fetch() & working with a simple API

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** JS syntax + variables + types
- › **Day 2:** Functions, arrays, objects, loops
- › **Day 3:** DOM selection + manipulation
- › **Day 4:** Events + event listeners
- › **Day 5:** Form validation + ES6 features
- › **Day 6:** fetch() + build project
- › **Day 7:** Review + debug practice

MINI-PROJECT

Interactive To-Do List + Live Form Validator. Add/delete/complete tasks (saved in localStorage), plus a registration form that validates email, password strength and shows inline error messages — all in vanilla JS.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Weather / quote app using a public API. Fetch live data from a free API, handle loading and error states, and render results dynamically into the DOM. No copy-paste — understand every line.

PHP Fundamentals & MySQL Intro

Cross from front-end into back-end. Run your first server-side code and talk to a database.

TOPICS

- › How PHP works (server vs client), XAMPP setup
- › Syntax, variables, data types, operators
- › Conditionals, loops, functions, arrays
- › Superglobals: \$_GET, \$_POST, \$_REQUEST
- › Form handling & basic validation
- › Intro to MySQL: databases, tables, SQL CRUD
- › Connecting PHP to MySQL with PDO / mysqli

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** PHP setup + syntax basics
- › **Day 2:** Control flow + functions + arrays
- › **Day 3:** Forms with \$_POST / \$_GET
- › **Day 4:** SQL basics (SELECT/INSERT/UPDATE/DELETE)
- › **Day 5:** PHP + MySQL connection (PDO)
- › **Day 6:** Build the project
- › **Day 7:** Review + month 1 recap

MINI-PROJECT

Contact form that saves to a database. A PHP form that validates input, inserts submissions into a MySQL table, and shows all messages on an admin page in a styled table. This is your first true full-stack feature.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Mini guestbook with edit + delete. Visitors post a message; an admin page lists all entries with working Edit and Delete buttons (full CRUD). Use prepared statements to prevent SQL injection from day one.

End of Month 1 — you should now be able to:

Build a responsive multi-section website from a design · use Flexbox & Grid confidently · add interactivity with vanilla JavaScript · write PHP that handles forms · create a MySQL database and run full CRUD from PHP · use Git & deploy to Netlify.

Month 2 — Core Development

Goal of the month: become a real back-end developer with PHP & MySQL, then enter the WordPress world — not as a user, but as a developer who builds custom themes.

WEEK 5

Advanced PHP — OOP, Sessions & Security

Write organized, reusable, secure PHP. Understand objects, sessions and how apps stay safe.

TOPICS

- › OOP: classes, objects, properties, methods
- › Constructors, inheritance, visibility (public/private)
- › Sessions & cookies (login state)
- › Password hashing (password_hash / verify)
- › Security: SQL injection, XSS, CSRF basics
- › File includes, code organization, MVC concept
- › Error handling & debugging

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** OOP classes & objects
- › **Day 2:** Inheritance + organizing code
- › **Day 3:** Sessions & cookies
- › **Day 4:** Password hashing + auth logic
- › **Day 5:** Security (injection, XSS, CSRF)
- › **Day 6:** Build secure login system
- › **Day 7:** Review + refactor

MINI-PROJECT

Secure user authentication system. Register, login, logout with hashed passwords, session-protected pages, and "remember me". Built with an OOP User class and prepared statements throughout.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Role-based access control. Extend the auth system so "admin" and "user" roles see different dashboards, and protected admin routes reject normal users. Add a CSRF token to every form.

Full PHP + MySQL Web App (CRUD Project Week)

Combine everything from Weeks 4–5 into one complete, real-world database application.

TOPICS

- › Project architecture & folder structure
- › Relational tables (one-to-many) & JOINS
- › Full CRUD with validation + flash messages
- › Search, filtering & pagination
- › Image / file uploads in PHP
- › Reusable header/footer includes
- › Clean URLs & basic .htaccess

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Plan DB schema + wireframe
- › **Day 2:** Auth + layout + structure
- › **Day 3:** Create + Read features
- › **Day 4:** Update + Delete + uploads
- › **Day 5:** Search, filter, pagination
- › **Day 6:** Polish UI + fix bugs
- › **Day 7:** Deploy + write README

PORTFOLIO PROJECT #1

Choose one full app: a Job Board, a School/Student Management panel, or an Inventory/POS system. Must have login, role-based dashboards, full CRUD, image upload, search + pagination. This becomes a real portfolio piece.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Add a dashboard with live stats. Build an admin dashboard showing counts and a simple chart (total records, today's entries, recent activity) using SQL aggregate queries (COUNT, GROUP BY) feeding a Chart.js graph.

WordPress Fundamentals (Developer Mindset)

Master WordPress as a power user and understand how it works under the hood — the foundation for theme dev.

TOPICS

- › Install WP locally (Local / XAMPP)
- › Dashboard, posts, pages, media, menus
- › Themes & plugins: how they work
- › WordPress file & database structure
- › Page builders (Elementor) vs. code
- › Essential plugins (forms, SEO, security, cache)
- › Users, roles, settings, permalinks

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Install WP + explore dashboard
- › **Day 2:** Posts, pages, categories, menus
- › **Day 3:** Themes & plugins ecosystem
- › **Day 4:** Elementor full build
- › **Day 5:** WP file + DB structure
- › **Day 6:** Build a complete site
- › **Day 7:** Review + backup/migrate practice

MINI-PROJECT

Complete business website with Elementor. A 5–6 page site (Home, About, Services, Blog, Contact) with a contact form, SEO plugin configured, and a child theme installed. Fast, responsive, professional.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Migrate a site. Take your finished WordPress site and migrate it from local to a free/cheap live host (or another local install) using a migration plugin + manual database export. Migration is a real, billable skill.

Custom WordPress Theme Development from Scratch

The leap from "WordPress user" to "WordPress developer". Build a theme by hand — no builder.

TOPICS

- › Theme file structure (style.css, index.php, functions.php)
- › The Template Hierarchy
- › The Loop, template tags, get_header/footer
- › Enqueuing CSS & JS properly
- › header.php, footer.php, sidebar.php, single.php, page.php
- › Menus, widgets & theme support
- › Converting a static HTML template into a WP theme

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Theme structure + style.css header
- › **Day 2:** Template hierarchy + The Loop
- › **Day 3:** Split header/footer + enqueue assets
- › **Day 4:** single.php, page.php, archive.php
- › **Day 5:** Menus + widgets + theme support
- › **Day 6:** Convert a HTML template → theme
- › **Day 7:** Review + month 2 recap

PORTFOLIO PROJECT #2 (START)

Convert your Week 2 HTML landing page into a fully custom WordPress theme. Editable content, working blog, dynamic menu, and a widget-ready footer — 100% hand-coded, zero page builder.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Make the homepage fully dynamic. Pull the latest 3 blog posts, a testimonials section, and services into the homepage using custom WP_Query loops — so the client can edit everything from the dashboard.

End of Month 2 — you should now be able to:

Write OOP PHP · build a secure login + full CRUD web app · protect against injection/XSS/CSRF · deliver a complete WordPress site · and hand-code a custom WordPress theme from a static design. You're now genuinely employable for junior work.

Month 3 — Expert Level & SEO

Goal of the month: advanced WordPress development (the skills clients actually pay well for), professional SEO from on-page to technical, and three polished capstone projects for the portfolio.

WEEK 9

Advanced WordPress — CPT, ACF, Hooks & WooCommerce

Unlock the WordPress skills that separate a \$5 developer from a \$30+/hr developer.

TOPICS

- › Custom Post Types & custom taxonomies
- › Advanced Custom Fields (ACF) & field groups
- › Hooks: actions & filters (the heart of WP)
- › Shortcodes & building a simple plugin
- › WooCommerce setup, products, checkout, templates
- › Customizing WooCommerce with hooks
- › Theme/child-theme overrides & template parts

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Custom Post Types + taxonomies
- › **Day 2:** ACF + display custom fields
- › **Day 3:** Actions & filters deep dive
- › **Day 4:** Build your first mini-plugin
- › **Day 5:** WooCommerce store setup
- › **Day 6:** Customize Woo with hooks
- › **Day 7:** Review + integrate into theme

MINI-PROJECT

A "Portfolio" or "Properties" CPT-driven site. Create a custom post type with ACF fields (e.g. price, location, gallery), a custom archive + single template, and filtering — the exact pattern real estate/portfolio clients ask for.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Build a small functional WooCommerce store + a custom plugin. Add a real product catalog, then write a small plugin that adds a custom feature (e.g. a "delivery note" field at checkout, or a custom dashboard widget). Plugin development = premium skill.

SEO Foundations — On-Page & Technical

Understand how Google ranks pages and how to optimize a site so it actually gets found.

TOPICS

- › How search engines crawl, index & rank
- › Keyword research (intent, volume, difficulty)
- › On-page SEO: titles, meta, headings, URL, alt text
- › Content structure & internal linking
- › Technical SEO: sitemap.xml, robots.txt, schema
- › Core Web Vitals & page speed basics
- › Mobile-friendliness & crawlability

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** How SEO & ranking works
- › **Day 2:** Keyword research + tools
- › **Day 3:** On-page optimization checklist
- › **Day 4:** Internal linking + content silos
- › **Day 5:** Technical: sitemap, robots, schema
- › **Day 6:** Speed + Core Web Vitals
- › **Day 7:** Full on-page audit of a site

MINI-PROJECT

Fully optimize your Month 2 WordPress site. Configure an SEO plugin (Rank Math / Yoast), write optimized titles & meta for every page, add schema, generate a sitemap, and fix all on-page issues. Document before/after.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Write a real keyword strategy. Pick a niche (e.g. a plumber in Dublin). Build a keyword map of 15–20 target keywords grouped by page + intent, with primary/secondary keywords and suggested URL structure — the deliverable a client would actually pay for.

Advanced SEO — Off-Page, Local, Analytics & Audits

Go from "I optimized a page" to "I can run a full SEO campaign and prove the results".

TOPICS

- › Off-page SEO: backlinks, authority, outreach
- › Local SEO + Google Business Profile
- › Google Search Console (setup & reading data)
- › Google Analytics 4 basics
- › Running a full SEO audit (Screaming Frog free)
- › Fixing 404s, redirects (301) & broken links
- › Reporting & tracking rankings

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Off-page + backlink fundamentals
- › **Day 2:** Local SEO + Google Business Profile
- › **Day 3:** Search Console setup + insights
- › **Day 4:** GA4 basics + tracking
- › **Day 5:** Full site crawl/audit
- › **Day 6:** Redirects, 404 cleanup, fixes
- › **Day 7:** Build a client-style SEO report

MINI-PROJECT

Complete SEO Audit Report (PDF). Crawl a real website, document every issue (technical, on-page, speed, content) and present fixes + priorities in a clean client-ready report. This single deliverable wins freelance clients.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Set up a measurable mini-campaign. Connect Search Console + GA4 to a live site, submit the sitemap, set a target keyword, and create a tracking sheet to monitor impressions/clicks/position over time. Learn to *prove* SEO works.

Capstone, Portfolio, Deployment & Going Pro

Tie everything together: finished projects, a live portfolio, real hosting skills, and a freelance-ready profile.

TOPICS

- › Buying domain + hosting, cPanel basics
- › Deploying via FTP (FileZilla) & managing files
- › SSL, backups, performance & security hardening
- › Building a personal portfolio website
- › Writing case studies for each project
- › Setting up GitHub + Upwork/Fiverr profiles
- › Pricing, proposals & client communication basics

DAILY PLAN

- › **Day 1:** Finalize capstone project
- › **Day 2:** Deploy live (domain + hosting)
- › **Day 3:** Build portfolio site
- › **Day 4:** Write 3 project case studies
- › **Day 5:** Polish GitHub + resume
- › **Day 6:** Create freelance profiles + proposals
- › **Day 7:** Final review + next-steps plan

PORTFOLIO PROJECT #3

Final Capstone: a complete client-style WordPress website — custom theme, CPT + ACF, WooCommerce (if relevant), fully SEO-optimized, deployed live on real hosting with SSL. The flagship piece of the portfolio.

COMPLEX CHALLENGE

Ship it like a freelancer. Deliver the capstone exactly as you would to a paying client: live URL, admin login handover doc, a short Loom-style walkthrough, an SEO report, and an invoice. Practising delivery is as important as building.

PROOF OF SKILL

The 3 Capstone Projects (Portfolio)

By the end, these three finished, deployed projects prove the student can be hired. Each one maps to a different revenue stream.

#	Project	Built across	Skills it proves to a client
1	Custom PHP + MySQL Web App (Job board / School system / Inventory)	Weeks 4–6	Real back-end logic, secure auth, database design, full CRUD — shows you can build custom software, not just sites.
2	Custom WordPress Theme (hand-coded from a static design)	Weeks 7–9	You're a WordPress <i>developer</i> , not just a user — CPT, ACF, custom loops, WooCommerce. This is the highest-demand skill.
3	SEO-Optimized Live Business Site + Audit	Weeks 10–12	You can build <i>and</i> rank. On-page + technical SEO, a professional audit report, live deployment — full-package value.

Bonus stretch project (optional, for the ambitious)

Combine PHP skills + WordPress by building a **simple custom WordPress plugin** that solves one real problem (e.g. a lead-capture form that saves to a custom DB table and exports CSV). A custom plugin in the portfolio instantly signals "advanced developer" and commands higher rates.

Suggested free/low-cost resources

Area	Where to learn
HTML / CSS / JS	freeCodeCamp, MDN Web Docs, The Odin Project, Flexbox Froggy & Grid Garden
PHP & MySQL	PHP official docs, Programming with Mosh (PHP), W3Schools SQL, Laracasts (PHP basics)
WordPress dev	WordPress Developer Resources (official), WPBeginner, Tube tutorials on "WordPress theme from scratch"
SEO	Google Search Central docs, Ahrefs blog & free YouTube course, Moz Beginner's Guide, Rank Math docs
Practice	Frontend Mentor (real design challenges), GitHub (host every project)

Final Skills Checklist & Next Steps

Tick each skill only when it can be done **without a tutorial open**. This is the honest measure of "expert level".

Area	I can confidently...	✓
Front-End	Build a responsive site from a design using Flexbox & Grid	
	Add interactivity & form validation with vanilla JavaScript	
	Fetch and display data from an API	
PHP / MySQL	Build a full CRUD app with secure login (OOP + PDO)	
	Design relational tables and write JOINS	
	Prevent SQL injection, XSS and CSRF	
WordPress	Hand-code a custom theme from a static design	
	Use CPT, ACF, custom WP_Query, hooks & filters	
	Build a WooCommerce store and a basic custom plugin	
SEO	Do keyword research and full on-page optimization	
	Run a technical SEO audit and fix the issues	
	Set up Search Console + GA4 and report results	
Pro Skills	Deploy a site live (domain, hosting, FTP, SSL)	
	Hand over a project + write a clean proposal/invoice	

After the 3 months — the growth path

- 1 First 30 days:** apply to junior roles + start on Fiverr/Upwork with the 3 capstones. Offer a small "starter" service (e.g. a one-page WordPress site or an SEO audit) to land the first reviews.
- 2 Months 4–6:** specialize. Pick a lane — WordPress theme/plugin dev, or WordPress + SEO as a combined offer (this combo is highly billable). Build 2–3 more niche projects.
- 3 Level-up tech:** learn a JS framework (React) or a PHP framework (Laravel) to move toward higher-paying app work, and learn Shopify/Liquid if e-commerce interests them.
- 4 Raise rates:** as the portfolio and reviews grow, move from low hourly to fixed-price packages. Real projects + proof of results = pricing power.

Final word for the student

Consistency beats intensity. Three to four focused hours every single day for 12 weeks — with real projects, not just tutorials — is genuinely enough to go from beginner to a hireable, freelance-ready web developer. Build in public, ship every project, and let the portfolio do the talking.